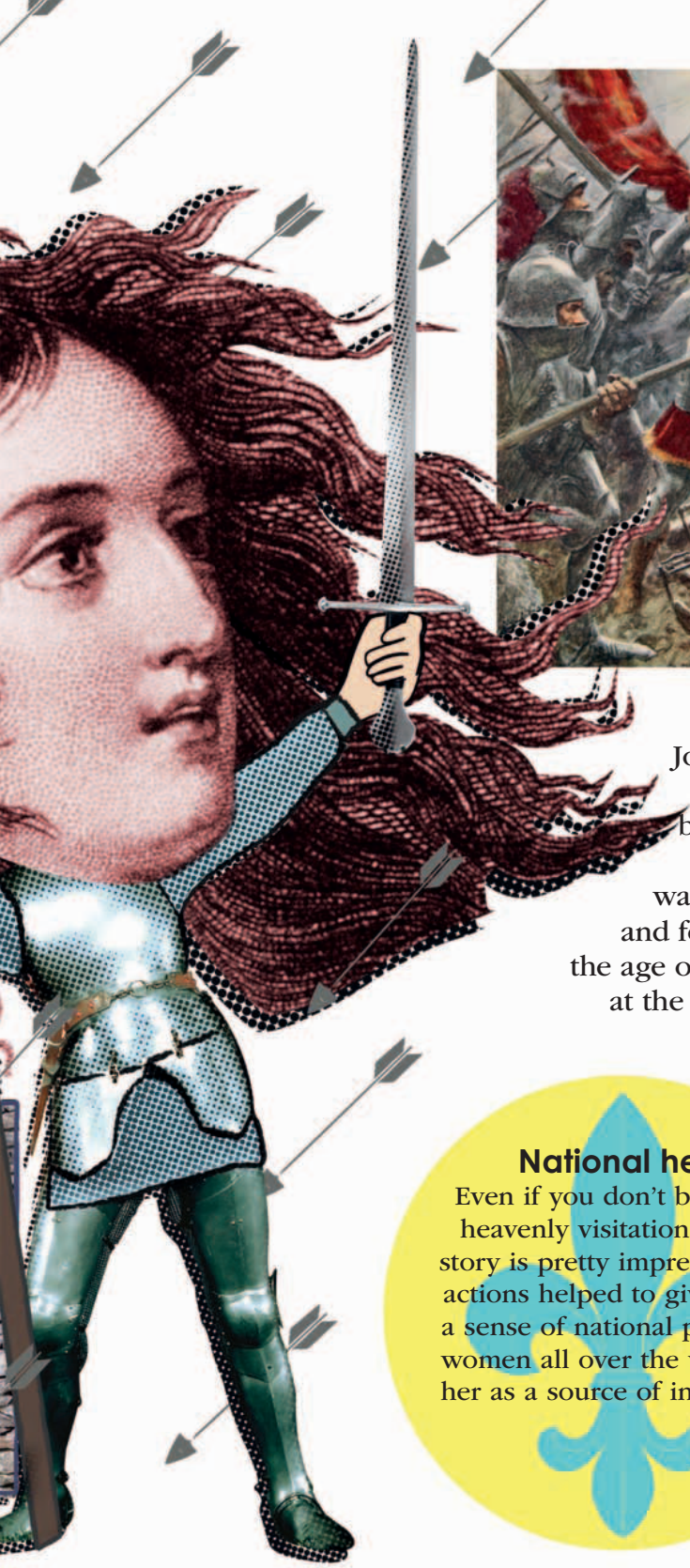




Teenage warrior

Not wanting to disobey a **heavenly vision**, Joan talked her way into the French army when she was 17 years old. After persuading the French ruler, the Dauphin Charles, to support her, she was given command of the army, rescued the city of Orléans from an **English siege**, and went on to lead the army to a series of **SPECTACULAR** victories.

End of the road

Joan's luck ran out when she was **captured** in battle at Compiègne and sold to the English. She was put on trial for heresy and found **guilty**. In 1431, at the age of 19, she was **BURNED** at the stake at Rouen, France.



National hero

Even if you don't believe in heavenly visitations, Joan's story is pretty impressive. Her actions helped to give France a sense of national pride, and women all over the world see her as a source of inspiration.

Did you know?
Pope Callixtus III declared that Joan was innocent 25 years after her execution, and then proclaimed her a martyr.

In 1429, the Italian poet **CHRISTINE DE PIZAN** (1363–c.1430) wrote the first poem about Joan's achievements, adding to Joan's legendary status.



In 1920, **POPE BENEDICT XV** (1854–1922) declared Joan of Arc a saint. Today, she is a very popular saint in the Catholic Church.

